ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 3

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 100

Marking guideline for the Academic Central NC(V) Level 3 English First Additional Language practice exam.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 3. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training marking guideline.

How to mark: each ✓ is one mark. Accept answers in the student's own words if the meaning is correct. Do not penalise spelling in Section A unless the meaning is lost. Section D is marked with the rubric at the end of this memo.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

1.1 They phoned a few references ✓ (1)

1.2 All the information a person leaves behind on the Internet ✓ every time he or she uses it, which others can find later ✓. (2)

1.3 Any THREE: photos you post ✓; comments you write ✓; groups you join ✓; posts you "like" (3)

1.4 Spoken words are soon forgotten / disappear ✓, but online posts remain and can be found again ✓. (2)

1.5 Someone may already have taken a screenshot ✓; the post may still be stored on a server ✓. (2)

1.6 Offensive language ✓; insults aimed at former employers ✓; photos showing irresponsible behaviour ✓; false information about qualifications ✓ (4)

1.7 If the candidate speaks badly about her current boss in public ✓, she may also speak badly about Thandeka's company / she may be negative and disloyal ✓. (2)

1.8 The writer moves from the dangers / negative side ✓ to the advantages / positive side of a digital footprint ✓. (2)

1.9 Any TWO: a professional profile on a networking site ✓; a video of a project ✓; a blog explaining how a technical problem was solved; a manager seeing their work online (2)

1.10 A grandmother represents someone whose opinion we respect / who would be upset by bad behaviour ✓; the tone is light / humorous ✓. (2)

1.11 Search for your own name ✓; delete or hide unsuitable content and tighten privacy settings ✓; build a positive presence by sharing achievements and commenting thoughtfully ✓. (3)

1.12 Before posting, imagine the post on a public billboard with your name ✓; if you would not be proud of it, do not post it ✓. (2)

1.13 Open answer: a clear opinion ✓ with a logical justification ✓✓ (e.g. fair – posts are public and show attitude; unfair – private life should be separate from work) (3)

[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

SEVEN points in full sentences (1 mark each), plus up to 3 marks for language:

1. Draw up a monthly budget. ✓
2. Cook your own meals in bulk. ✓
3. Buy second-hand textbooks or borrow from the library. ✓
4. Walk or share lifts to save on transport. ✓
5. Ask for student discounts. ✓
6. Do not buy on credit. ✓
7. Save a small amount every month for emergencies. ✓

Content ✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ (7) Language ✓✓✓ (3). Deduct 1 mark if longer than 80 words or if the word count is missing. (10)

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

3.1 Students ✓ – "Students, why pay more …" / "Stream lectures, download notes" / "Student card required" ✓ (2)

3.2 Any TWO: "GO FURTHER, PAY LESS!" ✓; "double the data" ✓; "half the price"; "this month only!"; "stay connected 24/7"; rhetorical question "why pay more …?" (2)

3.3 Half of the data (5 GB) is night data that can only be used between 00:00 and 05:00 ✓, so students really get only 5 GB of useful data / they need a student card and it expires after 30 days ✓. (2)

3.4 "Buffer" means a video stops while loading because of slow data ✓; the slogan suggests that with ConnectPro your future / progress will not be slowed down or interrupted ✓. (2)

3.5 Student discounts are offered ✓ by many shops ✓. (2)

3.6 Thandeka said that ✓ she would check ✓ every applicant's profile the following day / the next day ✓. (3)

3.7 Any correct completion with "would have", e.g. "… I would have avoided the embarrassment." ✓ (1)

3.8 Neither the students nor the lecturer was aware of the change. ✓ (the verb agrees with the nearer subject) (1)

3.9 Metaphor ✓ – like a tattoo, a digital footprint is very difficult or impossible to remove ✓. (2)

3.10 applicant / candidate ✓ (1)

3.11 (a) irresponsible ✓ (b) illegal ✓ (2)

3.12 How can students protect their privacy? ✓ (1)

3.13 The manager was extremely annoyed / fed up ✓ with employees who arrived late ✓. (2)

3.14 Correct use of each: "affect" is a verb, e.g. "Late-coming affects productivity." ✓; "effect" is a noun, e.g. "The new rule had a good effect." ✓ (2)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING – RUBRICS

Essay (20)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content and planning (12)	10–12: original, relevant, well-developed ideas; strong introduction and conclusion	7–9: relevant ideas with good detail	5–6: mostly relevant, some detail	0–4: few ideas, often off the topic
Language, style and editing (6)	6: varied vocabulary and sentences; very few errors	4–5: good vocabulary, few errors	3: simple but clear; some errors	0–2: many errors; meaning unclear
Structure (2)	2: clear paragraphs, logical order, correct length		0–1: poor paragraphing or far too short / long	

Transactional text (15)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content, planning and format (9)	8–9: all requirements covered; correct format; correct register	6–7: most requirements; format mostly correct	4–5: some requirements; format partly correct	0–3: task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (6)	6: very few errors	4–5: few errors	3: some errors	0–2: many errors

QUESTION 4

4.1 Discursive or argumentative: both sides discussed (or a clear position), with examples such as networking and learning versus cyberbullying, addiction and the digital footprint; balanced conclusion. [20]

4.2 Narrative that MUST begin with the given words; suspense, a clear plot (complication, climax, resolution). [20]

4.3 Reflective / expository: skills named (e.g. communication, teamwork, reliability, problem-solving, digital literacy), why employers value them, concrete examples of how the writer is developing them. [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5

5.1 **CV** – personal details (name, contact details; ID and age optional – not required by law); career objective; education and qualifications (NC(V) Level 2 completed, Level 3 in progress); skills; work experience or practicals; achievements / interests; references (names and contact numbers). Neat headings and layout. [15]

5.2 **Letter of complaint** – sender's address and date; recipient (The Customer Service Manager, ConnectPro); "Dear Sir/Madam"; subject line; facts (date bought, amount, problem with night data); request for action (refund or usable data); firm but polite tone; "Yours faithfully"; signature and name. [15]

5.3 **Minutes** – heading (name of body, date, time, venue); present and apologies; opening; matters discussed (cost of data) with decisions and action steps (who will do what by when); date of next meeting; closure; signatures of chairperson and secretary. Past tense, reported speech. [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE